

STATE OF NORTH CAROLINA

COUNTY OF VANCE

The Vance County Board of Commissioners met in regular session on Tuesday, September 2, 2025 at 6:00 p.m. in the commissioners' conference room, Vance County Administration Building, 122 Young Street, Henderson, NC. Those commissioners present were as follows: Chair Carolyn Faines, Vice-Chair Yolanda J. Feimster, Commissioners R. Dan Brummitt, Charisse Fain, Thomas S. Hester, Jr., Leo Kelly, Jr., and Valencia L. Perry.

Absent: None.

Also present were County Manager C. Renee Perry, Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones, Finance Director Stephanie Williams, County Attorney Jonathan S. Care, and Clerk to the Board Kelly H. Grissom.

Associate Pastor Ryan Hill, Clearview Baptist Church, gave the invocation.

Mr. Frankie Nobles, Vance County Employee Engagement Team Chair, was first on the agenda to recognize the new employee of the month. He noted that employees are nominated by their peers, and this month's recognition goes to Vicky Woodruff with the Department of Social Services. Her peers noted that she is a team player, has strong initiative, and is extremely productive. Ms. Woodruff will receive a monetary gift and a designated parking space for the month. She was presented with a plaque of appreciation, and the board congratulated her on receiving this recognition.

Ms. Argretta Johen, Employee Engagement Team member, then recognized the employee of the year. She noted that the employee of the year is chosen from the past year's employees of the month. Each candidate was rated on a scale of 1 to 5 in the categories of teamwork, initiative, attendance, and who goes above and beyond when needed. This year's recognition goes to Special Projects Manager Frankie Nobles. His peers noted that he is extremely dependable, is always willing to help in any way possible, and always has a positive attitude. Mr. Nobles received a plaque and a monetary gift. A reception will be held in his honor on Friday, September 19 at 12:00 noon.

Public comments were heard next. Mr. Eugene Myrick appeared before the board and stated that he and his wife purchased a house about three years ago at 728 East Avenue for his in-laws. Since then, the mother-in-law passed away and the father-in-law is unable to live alone. He stated that the home is a five-bedroom, three-bathroom house that has been renovated. He offered

the property to the city and/or county to be used as housing for homeless veterans, a group home, travel nurses, etc. if interested.

Doctor K. Aal-Anubia, Magnetic Lighthouse Community and Economic Development Corporation, noted that he appeared before the board a couple of months ago and requested a letter of support from the county to help secure a \$1.5M grant from the National Science Foundation Smart and Connected Communities. Following that meeting, he was informed by the county manager that his request had been denied. He again asked for a letter of support from the county and stated that the initiative is intended to create a legacy of innovation for the county and honor our veterans' stories with an interactive holographic memorial with no financial risk to the county.

Special Projects Manager Frankie Nobles was next on the agenda for a special recognition of the maintenance staff. He stated that these are the unseen heroes who keep county buildings clean and operational. He noted that in April of this year, county maintenance staff took over the maintenance of the detention center. Since that time, they have cleaned, painted and made repairs to the facility, all while keeping up with their regular duties. He thanked the maintenance team for their hard work over the past few months and recognized the following: Tempe Young, Carl James, Mike Lumpkin, Jamie Lassiter, and Lonnell Tarleton. Each was presented with a plaque of appreciation, and the board thanked them for all they do for the county.

Ms. Freddie Harris, Sisters Speak Life, appeared before the board as a two-time breast cancer survivor to spread the word on breast cancer awareness. Also appearing were members of her board and several community partners. She stated that the goal of Sisters Speak Life is to inspire hope, provide education, and connect women to screenings and needed support services. This year's theme is "Pink Out Vance County". The group shared their experiences and spoke on the importance of early detection. Ms. Harris noted that a mammogram truck will be at the Aycock Recreation Center on November 1 from 9:00 a.m. to 4:00 p.m. and distributed information on how to make an appointment. The group also informed the board that numerous downtown businesses will be displaying pink ribbons during the month of October and stated that ribbons are available to purchase through the Sisters Speak Life website.

Following comments by the board, motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt to display pink ribbons at all county buildings during the month of October. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain and unanimously approved.

Schools Superintendent Cindy Bennett and Schools Chief Finance Officer John Suther appeared before the board and informed them of an opportunity to apply for a \$47.2M capital needs grant with the NC Department of Public Instruction for 14 school facilities. She explained that there is a separate grant application for each facility and noted that some or all applications could be approved or denied. The Needs-Based Public School Capital Fund was established to assist counties with their critical capital needs. Grants from the NBPSCF are funded with revenue from the NC Education Lottery. Grant funds are available to eligible counties for construction of new school buildings and additions, repairs, and renovations of existing school facilities. Funds may not be used for real property acquisition or for capital improvements to administrative buildings. She noted that grant funding, if awarded, requires a 5% county match to be paid over the life of the grant (three to five years). She provided a copy of each grant application for each facility.

The board discussed this matter and agreed to allow staff to review the applications and the county's fund balance and bring back to the board during its special called meeting on September 16, 2025.

Sheriff Curtis Brame and Major Gregory Petrina, Jr. appeared before the board to request an extension of the Detention Center Emergency Pay Policy through December 31 to allow coverage while 12 new employees are trained. He stated that once they are trained, the emergency pay can cease.

Several commissioners and the county manager expressed their concerns with how much has been spent thus far on emergency pay. County Manager C. Renee Perry noted that since April, the county has spent \$483,550 on emergency pay. Ms. Perry stated that this is unsustainable and did not support an extension through December 31. She stated that if the board wishes to approve an extension, the policy will need to be revised. Major Petrina stated that many of those hours were for transportation of inmates throughout the state, from Cherokee County to Brunswick County.

Following discussion, motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. to allow staff to review the policy and bring back a recommendation to the board during its special called meeting on September 16, 2025. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. and unanimously approved.

Water District Board

Chair Carolyn Faines called the Water District Board to order. Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt noted that there is a new house being built on Chavis Road that has dug a well. He stated that it is his understanding that new constructions are required to connect to the water system if water is available. He asked staff to ensure our code enforcement and Envirolink are in communication with each other regarding this. The July 2025 monthly operations report was presented to the board for information. Chair Carolyn Faines adjourned the Water District Board.

Following the meeting, staff confirmed that new constructions are only required to connect to the water system if they are located in a subdivision.

Assistant County Manager's Report

Vehicle Use and Maintenance Policy. Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones reported that staff have conducted a comprehensive review and revision of the vehicle use policy to support consistent implementation across all county departments. The updated policy is designed to mitigate potential liability risks and to establish a uniform standard that can be applied county-wide. He noted that adoption of this policy will result in the repeal of the existing provisions within the county's personnel policy. The revised Vehicle Use and Maintenance Policy will serve thereafter as a standalone document. Recommendation: Repeal the current policy and approve the revised Vehicle Use and Maintenance Policy.

Following brief discussion, motion was made by Commissioner Charisse Fain, seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote unanimous, to repeal the current vehicle use policy and approve the revised Vehicle Use and Maintenance Policy as presented.

County Manager's Report

Breast Cancer Awareness Month Proclamation. County Manager C. Renee Perry stated that Breast Cancer Awareness Month is an international health campaign that is held every October. The month aims to promote screening and prevention of the disease, which affects 2.3 million women worldwide. Known best for its pink theme color, the month features a number of campaigns and programs conducted by groups ranging from breast cancer advocacy organizations to local community organizations. Recommendation: Approve the proclamation in support of Breast Cancer Awareness Month.

Motion was made by Commissioner Charisse Fain, seconded by Commissioner Yolanda J. Feimster, vote unanimous, to approve the following proclamation in support of Breast Cancer Awareness Month.

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PROCLAMATION
by the
Vance County Board of Commissioners
in recognition of
Breast Cancer Awareness Month

WHEREAS, October is National Breast Cancer Awareness Month; and

WHEREAS, National Breast Cancer Awareness Month is an annual campaign to increase awareness of this disease and increase public knowledge about the importance of early detection of breast cancer diagnosis and treatment; and

WHEREAS, breast cancer is the second most commonly diagnosed form of cancer for women in the United States and remains the second leading cause of cancer death among American women; and

WHEREAS, mammography is recognized as the single most effective method of detecting breast changes long before physical symptoms can be seen or felt; and

WHEREAS, early detection and improved treatment is believed to have significantly reduced the number of deaths caused by breast cancer; and

WHEREAS, this month-long observance serves as a reminder to all citizens to prioritize their health by scheduling regular screenings, learning about risk factors, and engaging in conversations about breast cancer prevention; and

WHEREAS, Vance County acknowledges the incredible work of healthcare professionals, researchers, support organizations, and survivors who tirelessly strive to improve treatment outcomes, enhance quality of life, and find a cure for breast cancer.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT PROCLAIMED, that the Vance County Board of Commissioners does hereby recognize October 2025 as Breast Cancer Awareness Month and encourages all citizens to participate in educational programs, screenings and events that raise awareness about breast cancer and support those affected by the disease.

This, the 2nd day of September, 2025.

Carolyn Faines (signed)
Carolyn Faines, Chair

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Fall Litter Sweep Proclamation. Ms. Perry stated that in the spring and fall of each year, the NC Department of Transportation (NCDOT) sponsors cleanup campaigns to beautify the roadsides of the state. This year, DOT is sponsoring its Fall Litter Sweep Campaign from September 13 - 27, 2025. Vance County encourages individuals and organizations to support this effort. Recommendation: Approve the proclamation designating September 13 - 27, 2025 as Fall Litter Sweep in Vance County.

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WHEREAS, in conjunction with the North Carolina Department of Transportation, Vance County supports and encourages participation in the Fall 2025 roadside cleanup effort to ensure clean and beautiful roads throughout the county; and

WHEREAS, Adopt-A-Highway volunteers, community service workers, community leaders, civic and community organizations, businesses, churches, schools, and environmentally concerned citizens conduct local cleanups during Litter Sweep and may receive Certificates of Appreciation for participation; and

WHEREAS, the cleanup effort will increase the awareness of the need for cleaner roadsides, emphasize the importance of anti-litter campaigns, and emphasize the recycling of solid wastes such as glass, metals, and plastics; and

WHEREAS, the Litter Sweep cleanup will be a part of educating the children and citizens of the county regarding the importance of a clean environment to the quality of life in Vance County.

NOW, THEREFORE BE IT PROCLAIMED, that the Vance County Board of Commissioners does hereby recognize September 13 - 27, 2025 as “Fall Litter Sweep” in Vance County and encourages all citizens to take an active role in making the community a cleaner and more beautiful place in which to live.

THIS, the 2nd day of September, 2025.

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Fireworks Permit – Tourism. Ms. Perry stated that Vance County Tourism has requested approval of a fireworks permit for its New Year’s Eve celebration at Satterwhite Point Park at Kerr Lake on Wednesday, December 31, 2025. According to Tourism Director Pam Hester, the TDA will obtain the necessary permits and approvals from NC State Parks and the Corps of Engineers, and the show will be contracted with a professional pyrotechnics firm which has the appropriate

credentials and insurance coverage. Recommendation: Approve the request from Tourism for a permit and fee waiver to discharge fireworks at its New Year's Eve celebration at Satterwhite Point at Kerr Lake planned for Wednesday, December 31, 2025, contingent upon the necessary approvals from the fire marshal.

Motion was made by Commissioner Yolanda J. Feimster, seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote unanimous, to approve the request from Tourism for a permit and fee waiver to discharge fireworks at its New Year's Eve celebration at Satterwhite Point at Kerr Lake planned for Wednesday, December 31, 2025, contingent upon the necessary approvals from the fire marshal.

Opioid Settlement Funds. Ms. Perry noted that settlements have been reached in litigation against Alvogen, Inc., Amneal Pharmaceuticals LLC, Apotex Corp., Hikma Pharmaceuticals USA Inc. f/k/a West-Ward Pharmaceuticals Corp., Indivior Inc., Sun Pharmaceutical Industries, Inc., Viatris Inc., and Zydus Pharmaceuticals (USA) Inc., as well as their subsidiaries, affiliates, officers, and directors (the "Secondary Opioid Manufacturer Settlements"). These manufacturers will pay varying amounts under the settlement agreement over the next five to ten years. The North Carolina Association of County Commissioners and the North Carolina Department of Justice have negotiated and prepared a Third Supplemental Agreement for Additional Funds ("SAAF-3") to provide for the equitable distribution of the proceeds of the Secondary Opioid Manufacturer Settlements. In addition, settlements have been reached under the Purdue Pharma L.P.'s bankruptcy plan whereby Purdue Pharma L.P. ("Purdue") and members of the Sackler family will pay approximately \$7.4 billion to settle opioid claims across the nation. Funds coming to North Carolina from the Purdue/Sackler settlements would be subject to the equitable distribution of the proceeds as set forth in the Memorandum of Agreement ("MOA") which has already been approved by the Board. Recommendation: Authorize the county manager to execute the settlement agreements.

Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote unanimous, to authorize the county manager to execute the settlement agreements.

Joint City/County Inspections Agreement. Ms. Perry stated that the agreement between Vance County and the City of Henderson authorizes the county to enforce state building codes and regulations within the city limits. She noted that the city affirms that all ordinances to be enforced

have been legally adopted and authorizes the county to collect standard fees, fines, and penalties from Henderson residents just as it does countywide. The county will handle all building code enforcement, including permits, inspections, and related actions, while the city must cover costs for attorneys or consultants if legal challenges arise. The city must notify residents that the county will be administering and billing for enforcement services. She stated that the agreement is effective through June 30, 2026, automatically renewing yearly unless terminated with 180 days' notice. Upon termination, the city is responsible for notifying residents and ensuring a smooth transition, while the county retains control over permits already issued. Both parties must assign staff to fulfill their duties, and the county will notify the city if staffing shortages prevent enforcement. All revenues collected under this agreement belong to the county. Any changes must be made in writing and agreed upon by both parties. The agreement is governed by North Carolina law and enforceable in Vance County Superior Court. Recommendation: Authorize the county manager to execute the joint agreement with the City of Henderson.

Motion was made by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. to authorize the county manager to execute the joint inspections agreement with the City of Henderson. This motion was seconded by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt and unanimously approved.

Work Session Report – Opioid Committee. Ms. Perry reported that the board held its August work session on Monday, August 18, 2025. Staff discussed the current opioid committee structure and advised the board that it has not been updated since 2023, and its membership remains the same. Staff recommended restructuring the committee to include a broader, more inclusive membership. Suggested members include three commissioners, the county manager, representatives from the health department, LME/MCO, law enforcement, EMS, social services, courts, and reentry programs. Service providers such as treatment and harm reduction agencies should also be included. Community organizations, local business leaders, and individuals with lived experience are considered critical to ensure equitable outcomes. The committee will serve in an advisory capacity only. All recommendations will ultimately be presented to the board for final approval of opioid settlement spending. The board gave staff direction to move forward with the above recommendations. The vacancies on the committee have been advertised effective August 19, 2025.

Work Session Report – Sheriff's Office Staffing. Ms. Perry stated that during the work session, Sheriff Brame discussed the significant staff turnover in his office, particularly among

detention officers and deputies. Exit interviews indicate that the primary reasons for leaving are pay concerns. Salary compression has become a critical issue, with new hires earning wages close to, or in some cases higher than experienced staff, which creates dissatisfaction and further turnover. This situation forces us to rely heavily on overtime, increasing costs and putting additional pressure on remaining employees. Recruitment is challenging as surrounding counties and municipalities offer more competitive pay and benefits, drawing away qualified candidates. The cost of replacing and training staff is steadily rising, while service delivery and response times are impacted by staffing shortages. To stabilize the workforce, staff will work directly with the Sheriff to review compression and an incentive plan and bring it back to the board at the November meeting.

Consent Agenda

Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote unanimous, to approve the following consent agenda items as presented: Budget Amendment #10 - #15, July 2025 Tax Refunds and Releases, departmental monthly reports, and the minutes of the June 2, 2025 regular meeting, the August 4, 2025 regular meeting, and the August 18, 2025 work session.

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**Budget Amendment #10
FY 2025-2026
Animal Services**

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
Fund Balance Appropriated	10-399-439900	27,225
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$ 27,225
Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
Maintenance Equipment	10-599-500016	21,000
Restricted Donation Spending	10-599-500089	6,225
Total		\$ 27,225

Purpose: Approval for the rollover of funds for the maintenance agreement of the TDMA Radios and the unused restricted donations received for the Animal Shelter.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
September 2, 2025

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**Budget Amendment #11
FY 2025-2026
Farmers Market**

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
NC Community Foundation Grant	10-333-433313	2,000
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$ 2,000
Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
NC Community Foundation Expense	10-605-500111	2,000
Total		\$ 2,000

Purpose: Approval for acceptance of grant funds received from NC Community Foundation Grant for the Community Garden Ramp. No match is required for this grant.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
September 2, 2025

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Budget Amendment #12
FY 2025-2026
Schools

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
PSBF/Lottery Funds	10-370-437017	1,610,000
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$ 1,610,000
Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
PSBF/Lottery Funds Distribution	10-681-500101	1,610,000
Total		\$ 1,610,000

Purpose: Approval for acceptance of NC Lottery Funds to be distributed to Vance County Schools for repair and renovation projects.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
September 2, 2025

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Budget Amendment #13
FY 2025-2026
EMS

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
Fund Balance Appropriated	10-399-439900	9,600
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$9,600
Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
UNC PECC Grant - Restricted	10-530-500058	9,600
Total		\$ 9,600

Purpose: Approval to rollover the unused PECC Grant funds received from UNC in prior years for distribution.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
September 2, 2025

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Budget Amendment #14
FY 2025-2026
Sheriff

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
Fund Balance Appropriated	10-399-439900	23,918.07
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$23,918.07
Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
Maintenance Vehicles/Auto Supplies	10-510-500017	10,740.45
BJA Funds	10-514-500085	10,756.00
Donations	10-517-500033	2,421.62
Total		\$ 23,918.07

Purpose: Approval to rollover and use of the funds received from insurance claim to pay for vehicle repairs, unused BJA Grant Funds and unused Donations for use this fiscal year.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
September 2, 2025

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Budget Amendment #15
FY 2025-2026
Administration

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
KTRCOG Digital Opportunity Grant	10-380-438088	7,500
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$7,500
Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
Kerr-Tar Digital Opp. Expenses	10-440-500513	7,500
Total		\$ 7,500

Purpose: Approval for acceptance of the Kerr-Tar Council of Governments Digital Opportunity Grant. There is no required match for this grant.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
September 2, 2025

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TAX OFFICE REFUND AND RELEASE REPORT FOR JULY 2025

TAXPAYER NAMCE	TAX YR	REAL	PERSONAL	SOLID WASTE FEE	REASON
M & A USA INC	2019	\$0.00	\$546.63	0	PERS PROP BILLED
M & A USA INC	2020	\$0.00	\$546.64	0	PERS PROP BILLED
M & A USA INC	2021	\$0.00	\$546.63	0	PERS PROP BILLED
M & A USA INC	2022	\$0.00	\$546.63	0	PERS PROP BILLED
VAYA HEALTH	2022	\$4,159.39	\$0.00	0	GOVERNMENT EXEMP
FREDERICK TERRIE	2023	\$0.00	\$42.24	120	PERS PROP BILLED
M & A USA INC	2023	\$0.00	\$559.60	0	PERS PROP BILLED
VAYA HEALTH	2023	\$4,159.39	\$0.00	0	GOVERNMENT EXEMP
CROMER GARY	2024	\$0.00	\$259.82	0	PERS PROP BILLED
M & A USA INC	2024	\$0.00	\$465.05	0	PERS PROP BILLED
VAYA HEALTH	2024	\$4,808.05	\$0.00	0	GOVERNMENT EXEMP
THE PEOPLES CHOICE DCAMPBELL	2025	\$0.00	\$53.66	0	CORRECT SITUS
STEVENSON JEFFREY TODD	2025	\$0.00	\$74.26	0	SITUS IN GRANVIL
		TOTAL	TOTAL		
		\$13,126.83	\$3,641.16		

MONTHLY REPORTS: 911 Emergency Operations, Administrative Ambulance Charge-Offs, Cooperative Extension, EMS, Fire Department, Human Resources, Information Technology, Parks and Recreation, Planning and Development, Tax Collections, and Veterans Service.

Miscellaneous

Appointments. The following appointments were presented to the board for consideration:

Farmers Market Advisory Committee - three-year term
Appoint Yvonne Pegram to fill vacant position.

Opioid Committee
Appoint Javier Plummer to fill EMS position, appoint Caroline Burnette to fill Courts position, and appoint Catherine Hazlett to fill Health Department position.

America 250 NC Committee
Appoint Jerry Edmonds, Tim Hall, and Tem Blackburn to fill vacant positions.

Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt to approve the appointments as presented. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain and unanimously approved.

As there was no further business, at 7:50 p.m., motion was made by Commissioner Charisse Fain, seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote unanimous, that the meeting be adjourned.

Approved and signed October 6, 2025.

Carolyn Faines (signed)
Carolyn Faines, Chair